HrClouds HRMS — HR User Onboarding & Setup Master Guide

Document Version: 2.0
Target Audience: HR Administrators, People Operations & System Admins
Platform URL: `https://frontend.dev.hrclouds.in`
Purpose: End-to-end procedural guide for setting up an organization, configuring attendance policies, creating shifts, issuing employee invitations, assigning work schedules, and establishing leave management quotas.

Master Setup Order Flowchart

To ensure clean data integrity across HrClouds, **follow this exact sequential order**. Each module strictly depends on configurations established in the preceding steps:

```
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------+
  | PHASE 1: ORGANISATION FOUNDATION                                      |
  |   Step 1A: Create Office Locations   -> /dashboard/hr/attendance/locations|
  |   Step 1B: Create Departments        -> /dashboard/hr/departments      |
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                                         v
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  | PHASE 2: TIME & ATTENDANCE RULES (Must follow in this exact order)      |
  |   Step 2A: Attendance Policies       -> /dashboard/hr/attendance/policies |
  |   Step 2B: Work Shifts               -> /dashboard/hr/attendance/shifts   |
  |   Step 2C: Public & Company Holidays -> /dashboard/hr/attendance/holidays |
  |   Step 2D: Weekly Offs               -> /dashboard/hr/attendance/weekly-offs
  |   Step 2E: Earned Leave (Comp-Off)   -> /dashboard/hr/attendance/comp-off-policies
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  | PHASE 3: PEOPLE ONBOARDING & INVITES                                    |
  |   Step 3A: Issue Employee Invites    -> /dashboard/hr/invites           |
  |   Step 3B: Employee Accepts Invite & Sets Password via Email (48 hrs)   |
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  | PHASE 4: SCHEDULING & LEAVE QUOTAS (After employee accepts invite)      |
  |   Step 4A: Assign Work Shifts        -> /dashboard/hr/attendance/shift-assignments
  |   Step 4B: Create Leave Types        -> /dashboard/hr/leaves/types      |
  |   Step 4C: Create Leave Policies     -> /dashboard/hr/leaves/policies   |
  |   Step 4D: Assign Leave Policies     -> /dashboard/hr/leaves/policies   |
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```

Why Sequential Order is Mandatory in HRMS

> ***1. Office Locations must exist before Departments:***
> *Departments bind directly to an office location dropdown. Geofenced mobile attendance and location-specific holiday calendars also require an active Office Location record.*

> ***2. Policies & Shifts must exist before Employee Invites:***
> *When an employee joins on Day 1, their attendance evaluation criteria, scheduled working hours, and punch permissions must already exist.*

> ***3. Employees must be onboarded before assigning Shifts & Leave Policies:***
> *You cannot assign an employee to a work shift or credit their leave quota until their user profile exists in the active personnel directory.*

PHASE 1: Organisation Foundation Setup

In this phase, you establish the physical premises of your enterprise and construct the functional departments where staff will be deployed.

```
SETUP
  └── Organisation
      ├── Office Locations  -> /dashboard/hr/attendance/locations  (Step 1A)
      └── Departments       -> /dashboard/hr/departments           (Step 1B)
```

Step 1A: Create Office Locations

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Organisation` > `Office Locations`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/attendance/locations`
- **Primary Function:** Defines physical workplace premises and establishes circular GPS geofencing perimeters within which mobile punch-ins are validated.

Form Fields Specification & Data Dictionary

Field Name	Type & Requirement	Plain Language Explanation & Operational Usage
Location Name	Text Input `[Required *]`	The recognizable title of your office (e.g., *Indore Head Office*, *Bangalore Tech Hub*).
Location Code	Text Input `[Required *]`	Short alphanumeric code for reports and tax mapping (e.g., `IND-HO`, `BLR-01`).
Time Zone	Select Dropdown `[Required *]`	The official timezone of this office (e.g., `Asia/Kolkata (IST +05:30)`). Standardizes all clock timestamps.
Address	Textarea `[Required *]`	Complete physical street address, building number, and landmark.
Interactive Map	Map Picker `[Interactive]`	Click anywhere on the map pane to automatically position a GPS marker pin and populate coordinates.
Latitude	Numeric `[Required *]`	Exact GPS latitude coordinate (auto-populated by map or entered manually, e.g., `22.7533`).
Longitude	Numeric `[Required *]`	Exact GPS longitude coordinate (auto-populated by map or entered manually, e.g., `75.8937`).
Geofence Radius	Numeric `[Optional]`	Allowed boundary in meters from the pin for valid mobile clock-ins (Default: `100` meters).
City, State, Country, Pincode	Text Inputs `[Optional]`	Postal details for regional compliance, state professional tax slabs, and legal letters.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Navigate to:** `SETUP` > `Organisation` > `Office Locations` (`/dashboard/hr/attendance/locations`).
2. **Click button:** Click the primary `+ Add Location` button at the top-right.
3. **Fill basic details:**
   - Enter **Location Name** (e.g., `Indore Head Office`).
   - Enter **Location Code** (e.g., `IND-HO`).
   - Choose **Time Zone** (e.g., `Asia/Kolkata`).
   - Enter the full street **Address**.
4. **Set GPS Pin:** Use the interactive map on the left to locate your building and drop the GPS pin.
5. **Verify coordinates:** Confirm that **Latitude** and **Longitude** values have populated.
6. **Set boundary:** Set **Geofence Radius** (Recommended: `150` meters).
7. **Complete postal fields:** Enter **City**, **State**, **Country**, and **Pincode**.
8. **Save:** Click `Create Location` to finish.

Concrete Example Data:

```
Location Name: Indore Head Office
  Location Code: IND-HO
  Time Zone: Asia/Kolkata (IST +05:30)
  Address: Plot No. 42, Scheme 54, PU-4 Commercial Complex, Vijay Nagar
  Latitude: 22.7533
  Longitude: 75.8937
  Geofence Radius: 150 meters
  City: Indore
  State: Madhya Pradesh
  Country: India
  Pincode: 452010
```

Step 1B: Create Departments

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Organisation` > `Departments`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/departments`
- **Primary Function:** Categorizes your personnel into distinct business operations (e.g., Engineering, Sales, Human Resources) to establish reporting lines and departmental policy scopes.

Form Fields Specification & Data Dictionary

Field Name	Type & Requirement	Plain Language Explanation & Operational Usage
Department Name	Text Input `[Required *]`	The formal operational title of the department (e.g., `Information Technology`, `Human Resources`).
Department Code	Text Input `[Required *]`	Short alphanumeric code for grouping and employee numbering (e.g., `IT`, `HR`).
Location	Select Dropdown `[Optional]`	Binds the department to an Office Location created in Step 1A.
Parent Department	Select Dropdown `[Optional]`	Used when establishing sub-departments (e.g., *Frontend Team* under *Engineering*).
Head of Department	Search Popover `[Optional]`	Selects the Manager or HR lead who oversees this department. Can be left unassigned initially.
Description	Textarea `[Optional]`	Summary of the department's operational mandate and scope.
Department is Active	Checkbox `[Optional]`	Checked by default. Inactive departments cannot have new members assigned.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Navigate to:** `SETUP` > `Organisation` > `Departments` (`/dashboard/hr/departments`).

2. **Click button:** Click the primary `+ Add Department` button at the top-right.
3. **Fill department details:**
   - Enter **Department Name** (e.g., `Information Technology`).
   - Enter **Department Code** (e.g., `IT`).
   - Select **Location** from the dropdown (choose office created in Step 1A, e.g., `Indore Head Office`).
   - Leave **Parent Department** blank unless creating a sub-division.
   - Leave **Head of Department** blank initially (can be assigned after staff join).
   - Enter a functional **Description**.
   - Ensure **Department is Active** is checked.
4. **Save:** Click `Save Department`.
5. **Repeat:** Repeat these steps to create remaining departments (e.g., *Human Resources*, *Finance*, *Sales & Marketing*).

Concrete Example Data:

```
Department Name: Information Technology
  Department Code: IT
  Location: Indore Head Office
  Parent Department: None (Top Level)
  Head of Department: Unassigned (Leave blank during initial setup)
  Description: Software engineering, cloud infrastructure, IT support, and cyber securi
  ty operations.
  Department is Active: Checked (Yes)
```

PHASE 2: Time & Attendance Master Flow

Attendance rules, work shifts, holidays, and weekly off policies govern daily timesheets. **Follow this sequence strictly in this exact order**:

```
SETUP
  └── Time
      ├── Attendance Policies     -> /dashboard/hr/attendance/policies        (Step 2A)
      ├── Work Shifts             -> /dashboard/hr/attendance/shifts          (Step 2B)
      ├── Holidays                -> /dashboard/hr/attendance/holidays        (Step 2C)
      ├── Weekly Offs             -> /dashboard/hr/attendance/weekly-offs      (Step 2
  D)
      └── Earned Leave Policies   -> /dashboard/hr/attendance/comp-off-policies(Step 2
  E)
```

Step 2A: Create Attendance Policies

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Attendance Policies`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/attendance/policies`
- **Primary Function:** Establishes permissible punch modes (Web, Mobile, Geofenced), grace buffers for late arrivals, and penalties for tardiness or early departures.

Form Fields Specification & Data Dictionary

Field Name	Type & Requirement	Plain Language Explanation & Operational Usage
Policy Name	Text Input `[Required *]`	Descriptive title (e.g., `Standard Corporate Attendance Policy 2026`).
Priority	Numeric `[Optional]`	Precedence rank (e.g., `1`). Higher priority rules take precedence on conflict.
Punch Mode	Select Dropdown `[Required *]`	Permitted methods (e.g., *Web & Mobile*, *Geofenced Mobile*, *Biometric Device*).
Allow Web Punch	Toggle Switch `[Optional]`	When enabled, employees can clock in directly from their desktop web browser.
Allow Mobile Punch	Toggle Switch `[Optional]`	When enabled, employees can clock in using their smartphones.
Require Location / Geofence	Toggle Switch `[Optional]`	Mobile punches are only validated if the employee is physically inside the office geofence.
Late Arrival Grace Period	Numeric (mins) `[Optional]`	Allowed buffer past shift start (e.g., `15` minutes) before marking Late.
Late Mark Action	Select Dropdown `[Optional]`	Action triggered upon exceeding grace (e.g., *Flag Late*, *3 Late marks = 0.5 Day Pay Cut*).
Early Departure Action	Select Dropdown `[Optional]`	Action enforced if employee clocks out before scheduled shift end.
Earn Earned Leave for Holiday Work	Toggle Switch `[Optional]`	Automatically credits Compensatory Off when staff work on scheduled holidays.
Applies To Scope	Multi-Select `[Optional]`	Restrict to specific Departments or Locations. Leave blank for company-wide.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Navigate to:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Attendance Policies` (`/dashboard/hr/attendance/policies`).
2. **Click button:** Click **`Create Policy`** (or `+ Add Policy`) at the top-right.
3. **Set policy parameters:**
   - Enter **Policy Name** and set **Priority** to `1`.

- Select **Punch Mode** as `Web & Mobile`.
- Switch **Allow Web Punch** and **Allow Mobile Punch** to `ON`.
- Switch **Require Location / Geofence** to `ON` to enforce office boundary verification.
- Enter `15` in **Late Arrival Grace Period (mins)**.
- Set **Late Mark Action** to `Flag Late & Alert Manager`.
- Enable **Earn Earned Leave for Holiday Work**.
- Keep scope filters set to *All Departments* and *All Locations* for global coverage.

4. **Save:** Click `Save Policy`.

Concrete Example Data:

```
Policy Name: Standard Office Attendance Policy 2026
  Priority: 1
  Punch Mode: Web & Mobile (Geofenced)
  Allow Web Punch: Yes
  Allow Mobile Punch: Yes
  Require Location / Geofence: Yes (Enforce 150m boundary)
  Late Arrival Grace Period: 15 minutes
  Late Mark Action: Mark Late (3 late marks = 0.5 Day Loss of Pay)
  Early Departure Grace Period: 15 minutes
  Earn Earned Leave for Holiday Work: Enabled
  Applies To: All Locations, All Departments, Full-Time Employees
```

Step 2B: Create Work Shifts

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Work Shifts`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/attendance/shifts`
- **Primary Function:** Defines scheduled working hours, meal break deductions, and minimum hours required for Half-Day and Full-Day attendance credits.

> ***CRITICAL WORKFLOW NOTE: Shift Creation vs. Shift Assignment***
> *In this step, you are **only creating shift templates**. You cannot assign them to individual employees yet. After employees are invited and accept their invitations in Phase 3, you will assign these shifts in **Phase 4** via **Shift Assignments / Roster** (`/dashboard/hr/attendance/shift-assignments`).*

Form Fields Specification & Data Dictionary

Field Name	Type & Requirement	Plain Language Explanation & Operational Usage
Shift Name	Text Input `[Required *]`	Title of the shift (e.g., `General Day Shift (9:30 AM - 6:30 PM)`).
Shift Code	Text Input `[Required *]`	Unique short identifier for rosters (e.g., `GEN-01`, `NS-01`).
Shift Type	Select `[Required *]`	`Fixed Hours` (fixed start/end timestamps) vs. `Flexible Hours` (total duration driven).
Start Time	Time Picker `[Required *]`	Official scheduled start time (e.g., `09:30 AM`).
End Time	Time Picker `[Required *]`	Official scheduled end time (e.g., `06:30 PM`).
Break Duration	Numeric (mins) `[Optional]`	Standard unpaid meal break subtracted from total working time (e.g., `60` minutes).
Half Day Minimum Hours	Numeric (hours) `[Optional]`	Minimum active hours needed to qualify for half a day's wage (e.g., `4.5` hours).
Full Day Minimum Hours	Numeric (hours) `[Optional]`	Minimum active hours needed to achieve 100% Present status (e.g., `8.0` hours).
Grace Period	Numeric (mins) `[Optional]`	Shift-specific arrival buffer in minutes (e.g., `15` minutes).

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Navigate to:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Work Shifts` (`/dashboard/hr/attendance/shifts`).
2. **Click button:** Click `+ Add Shift` at the top-right.
3. **Configure shift:**
   - Enter **Shift Name** as `General Day Shift (9:30 AM - 6:30 PM)`.
   - Enter **Shift Code** as `GEN-01`.
   - Select **Shift Type** as `Fixed Hours`.
   - Set **Start Time** to `09:30 AM` and **End Time** to `06:30 PM`.
   - Enter **Break Duration** as `60` minutes.
   - Enter **Half Day Minimum Hours** as `4.5`.
   - Enter **Full Day Minimum Hours** as `8.0`.
   - Set **Grace Period** to `15` minutes.
4. **Save:** Click `Save Shift`.

Concrete Example Data:

```
Shift Name: General Day Shift (9:30 AM - 6:30 PM)
  Shift Code: GEN-01
  Shift Type: Fixed Hours
  Start Time: 09:30 AM
  End Time: 06:30 PM
  Break Duration: 60 minutes
  Half Day Minimum Hours: 4.5 hours
  Full Day Minimum Hours: 8.0 hours
  Grace Period: 15 minutes
```

Step 2C: Setup Public & Company Holidays

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Holidays`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/attendance/holidays`
- **Primary Function:** Publishes mandatory national paid public holidays and optional floating festival observances for the active operational calendar year.

Form Fields Specification & Data Dictionary

Field Name	Type & Requirement	Plain Language Explanation & Operational Usage
Holiday Name	Text Input `[Required *]`	Title of observance (e.g., `Republic Day`, `Diwali`, `Independence Day`).
Date	Date Picker `[Required *]`	Exact calendar date of observance.
Type	Radio Select `[Required *]`	`Mandatory` (Company-wide paid day off) vs. `Optional` (Floating festival day).
Description	Textarea `[Optional]`	Cultural notes or context regarding the occasion.
Applicable Locations	Checkboxes `[Optional]`	Location filters allowing regional state holidays to target specific branches.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Navigate to:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Holidays` (`/dashboard/hr/attendance/holidays`).
2. **Select year:** Choose active **Calendar Year** (e.g., `2026`) in the year dropdown.
3. **Click button:** Click `+ Add Holiday` (or `Import Calendar` for gazetted lists).
4. **Fill holiday fields:**
   - Enter **Holiday Name** (e.g., `Republic Day`).
   - Select **Date** (e.g., `26-01-2026`).
   - Select **Type** as `Mandatory`.

- Add a brief **Description**.
- Under **Applicable Locations**, select `All Locations`.

5. **Save:** Click `Save Holiday`.
6. **Repeat:** Repeat for the rest of your organization's annual holiday calendar.

Concrete Example Data:

```
Holiday Name: Republic Day
  Date: 26-01-2026
  Type: Mandatory
  Description: Indian National Public Holiday - Celebrates the Constitution of India.
  Applicable Locations: All Locations (Indore Head Office, etc.)
```

Step 2D: Setup Weekly Offs

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Weekly Offs`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/attendance/weekly-offs`
- **Primary Function:** Configures organizational rest days across the calendar week (e.g., 5-Day Mon–Fri schedule, 6-Day schedule, or Alternate Saturday arrangements).

Form Fields Specification & Data Dictionary

Field Name	Type & Requirement	Plain Language Explanation & Operational Usage
Policy Name	Text Input `[Required *]`	Descriptive name for work-week schedule (e.g., `Corporate 5-Day Work Week`).
Priority	Numeric `[Optional]`	Rule priority order (e.g., `1`). Higher priority policies override defaults.
Work Days	Day Pills `[Required *]`	Monday-Sunday toggles. Days left untoggled are designated as official paid Weekly Off days.
Alternate Saturday Schedule	Radio Select `[Required *]`	Options: `All Saturdays are working`, `All Saturdays are off`, or `Custom alternate Saturdays`.
Applies To Scope	Multi-Select `[Optional]`	Restricts this weekly off schedule to specific departments or locations.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Navigate to:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Weekly Offs` (`/dashboard/hr/attendance/weekly-offs`).
2. **Click button:** Click `+ Add Rule` (or `Add Policy`).
3. **Configure work days:**
   - Enter **Policy Name** as `Corporate 5-Day Work Week (Mon-Fri)`.

- Set **Priority** to `1`.
- Under **Work Days**, toggle ON `Monday`, `Tuesday`, `Wednesday`, `Thursday`, and `Friday`. (Leave `Saturday` and `Sunday` OFF).
- Under **Alternate Saturday Schedule**, select `All Saturdays are off`.
- Under **Applies To**, keep `All Departments` and `All Locations` selected.

4. **Save:** Click `Save Policy`.

Concrete Example Data:

```
Policy Name: Corporate 5-Day Work Week (Mon-Fri)
  Priority: 1
  Work Days: Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday, Friday
  Weekly Off Days: Saturday, Sunday
  Alternate Saturday Rule: All Saturdays are off
  Applies To: All Departments, Full-Time Staff
```

Step 2E: Setup Earned Leave Policies (Compensatory Off)

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Comp-Off Policies`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/attendance/comp-off-policies`
- **Primary Function:** Configures compensatory leave accrual ("Earned Leave / Comp-Off") awarded when staff work on scheduled rest days or recognized public holidays.

Form Fields Specification & Data Dictionary

Field Name	Type & Requirement	Plain Language Explanation & Operational Usage
Policy Name	Text Input `[Required *]`	Name of comp-off rule (e.g., `Standard Compensatory Off Policy`).
Priority	Numeric `[Optional]`	Rule priority integer (e.g., `1`).
Hours for Half Day	Numeric `[Required *]`	Minimum hours worked on a holiday to earn 0.5 comp-off day credit (e.g., `4.0` hours).
Hours for Full Day	Numeric `[Required *]`	Minimum hours worked on a holiday to earn 1.0 comp-off day credit (e.g., `8.0` hours).
Multiplier	Numeric `[Required *]`	Credit multiplier rate (Default: `1.0` = 1 day credit per 1 day worked).
Valid for (days)	Numeric `[Optional]`	Validity window before unused comp-off credits expire (e.g., `60` days).
Maximum Balance	Numeric `[Optional]`	Maximum cap on accumulated, unused comp-off credits (e.g., `5.0` days).
Requires Manager Approval	Checkbox `[Optional]`	When checked, extra hours must be approved by the manager before leave balance is credited.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Navigate to:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Comp-Off Policies` (`/dashboard/hr/attendance/comp-off-policies`).
2. **Click button:** Click `+ Add policy` at the top-right.
3. **Configure parameters:**
   - Enter **Policy Name** as `Standard Compensatory Off Policy`.
   - Set **Hours for half day** to `4.0` and **Hours for full day** to `8.0`.
   - Set **Multiplier** to `1.0`.
   - Enter `60` in **Valid for (days)** so credits lapse if unused after 2 months.
   - Enter `5.0` in **Maximum balance** to cap accumulated credits.
   - Check **Requires manager approval** to ensure overtime verification.
4. **Save:** Click `Save Policy`.

Concrete Example Data:

```
Policy Name: Standard Compensatory Off Policy
  Priority: 1
  Hours for Half Day: 4.0 hours
  Hours for Full Day: 8.0 hours
  Multiplier: 1.0
  Validity: 60 days
  Maximum Balance Cap: 5.0 days
  Requires Manager Approval: Yes (Checked)
  Applies To: All Employees
```

PHASE 3: People Onboarding — Inviting Team Members

Now that your organizational structure, attendance rules, shift templates, and holidays are live, you can safely issue invitations to new hires and existing staff.

```
PEOPLE
  ├── Inbox    -> /dashboard/hr/inbox
  ├── Team     -> /dashboard/hr/employees
  └── Invites -> /dashboard/hr/invites (Step 3A)
```

Step 3A: Issue Employee Invitations via the 4-Step Wizard

- **Sidebar Path:** `PEOPLE` > `Invites`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/invites`
- **Primary Function:** Pre-provisions complete personnel profiles, compliance credentials, and reporting lines, delivering a secure **48-hour email activation link** to the employee.

> ***CRITICAL PERMANENT FIELDS: Role & Gender Cannot Be Changed Afterwards***
> *The **Role** (`HR`, `Manager`, `Employee`) and **Gender** (`Male`, `Female`, `Other`) fields defined during this invitation **cannot be modified from the user profile interface afterwards**. Verify these two selections meticulously prior to clicking Send Invitation.*

Visual Architecture: The 4-Step Accordion Wizard

```
+-------------------------------------------------------------------------+
  | INVITE TEAM MEMBER WIZARD                                             |
  +-----------------------------------------------------------------------+
  | [Accordion 1] Required Information (Name, Email, Role, Gender)        |
  | [Accordion 2] Profile Details (Contact, DOB, Blood Group, Designation)|
  | [Accordion 3] Organization & Work (Location, Dept, Manager, Job Status)|
  | [Accordion 4] Compliance & Address (PAN, UAN, Residential Address)    |
  +-----------------------------------------------------------------------+
```

Detailed Breakdown of Accordion Sections & Fields:

1. Accordion Step 1: Required Information

- **Employee ID [Optional]:** Unique organizational badge code (e.g., `EMP-001`). If left blank, system auto-generates one.
- **Full Name [Required *]:** Legal first and last name of employee as on official documents.
- **Email Address [Required *]:** Corporate email address where the secure 48-hour activation link is sent.
- **Role [Required *]:** System permission tier:
  - `HR`: Full administrative rights across setup, payroll, and timesheets.
  - `Manager`: Team supervisory privileges (attendance adjustments, leave approvals).
  - `Employee`: Self-service portal access (clock in/out, view leaves, payslips).
- **Gender [Required *]:** `Male`, `Female`, `Other`. Crucial for validating gender-restricted leave quotas (Maternity/Paternity).

2. Accordion Step 2: Profile Details

- **Primary Contact [Required *]:** 10-digit primary mobile telephone number for verification.
- **Personal Email:** Secondary personal email address (e.g., Gmail) used for password recoveries.
- **Marital Status:** Dropdown: `Single`, `Married`, `Divorced`, `Widowed`.
- **Blood Group:** Medical blood type: `A+`, `A-`, `B+`, `B-`, `O+`, `O-`, `AB+`, `AB-`.
- **Date of Birth:** Format: `DD-MM-YYYY`.
- **Designation:** Professional corporate title (e.g., *Full Stack Developer*, *HR Lead*).

3. Accordion Step 3: Organization & Work

- **Location:** Dropdown populated by Office Locations created in Step 1A (e.g., `Indore Head Office`).
- **Department [Required *]:** Dropdown populated by Departments created in Step 1B (e.g., `Information Technology`).
- **Make Head Of Dept.:** `No` / `Yes`. (Only users with `Manager` or `HR` roles are eligible to head a department).

- **Reporting Person [Required *]:** Popover picker to designate direct supervisor. Auto-defaults to Department Head if available.

  > **ORGANIZATIONAL HIERARCHY RULE:**
  > Whenever the invitee's role is set to `Manager` or `HR`, their assigned Reporting Person **must strictly be an active HR user**.
- **Job Status [Required *]:** Current status: `Probation`, `Confirmed`, `Notice Period`, `Trainee`, `Intern`.
- **Employment Type [Required *]:** Contract classification: `Full Time`, `Part Time`, `Contract`, `Intern`.
- **Work Mode [Required *]:** Operational physical style: `On-site`, `Remote`, `Hybrid`.
- **Joining Date:** Formal first day of employment in `DD-MM-YYYY` format.

4. Accordion Step 4: Compliance & Address

- **PAN Number:** 10-character Indian Income Tax alphanumeric permanent account number (e.g., `ABCDE1234F`).
- **UAN Number:** 12-digit EPFO Universal Account Number for Provident Fund compliance.
- **Pincode:** 6-digit postal code.
- **Current Address:** Local residence where employee currently stays.
- **Permanent Address [Required *]:** Legal domicile. If identical to current address, check `Same as Current`.
- **City & State:** Municipal and state jurisdiction.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Navigate to:** `PEOPLE` > `Invites` (`/dashboard/hr/invites`).
2. **Click button:** Click the primary `+ New invite` button at the top-right.
3. **Complete Accordion 1 (Required Information):**
   - Enter `EMP-001` in Employee ID (or leave blank).
   - Enter Full Name as `Aman Sharma`.
   - Enter Work Email as `aman.sharma@yourcompany.com`.
   - Select Role as `Employee`.
   - Select Gender as `Male`.
4. **Expand Accordion 2 (Profile Details):**
   - Enter Primary Contact as `9876543210`.
   - Enter Personal Email as `aman.personal@gmail.com`.
   - Select Marital Status as `Single` and Blood Group as `O+`.
   - Enter Date of Birth as `15-08-1996`.
   - Enter Designation as `Full Stack Developer`.
5. **Expand Accordion 3 (Organization & Work):**
   - Select Location as `Indore Head Office`.
   - Select Department as `Information Technology`.

- Select Reporting Person via picker (select your HR Admin or Department Lead).
- Select Job Status as `Probation`.
- Select Employment Type as `Full Time`.
- Select Work Mode as `On-site`.
- Enter Joining Date as `01-11-2026`.

6. **Expand Accordion 4 (Compliance & Address):**
   - Enter PAN Number and UAN Number.
   - Enter Current Address and check the `Same as Current` box.
   - Enter City as `Indore` and State as `Madhya Pradesh`.
7. **Send:** Click the primary **`Send Invitation`** button.
8. **Confirmation:** The candidate profile appears in the **Waiting** tab on the Invites dashboard with a 48-hour countdown.

Concrete Example Data:

```
# Step 1: Required Information
  Employee ID: EMP-001
  Full Name: Aman Sharma
  Email Address: aman.sharma@yourcompany.com
  Role: Employee
  Gender: Male

  # Step 2: Profile Details
  Primary Contact: +91 9876543210
  Personal Email: aman.personal@gmail.com
  Marital Status: Single
  Blood Group: O+
  Date of Birth: 15-08-1996
  Designation: Full Stack Developer

  # Step 3: Organization & Work
  Location: Indore Head Office
  Department: Information Technology
  Make Head Of Dept: No
  Reporting Person: Abhishek HR
  Job Status: Probation
  Employment Type: Full Time
  Work Mode: On-site
  Joining Date: 01-11-2026

  # Step 4: Compliance & Address
  PAN Number: ABCDE1234F
  UAN Number: 100987654321
  Pincode: 452010
  Current Address: Flat 402, Lotus Heights, Scheme 54, Vijay Nagar
  Permanent Address: Same as Current
  City: Indore
  State: Madhya Pradesh
```

PHASE 4: Post-Join Setup — Scheduling & Leave Quotas

Once an employee opens their activation email, sets a secure password, and their status transitions from `Waiting` to `Accepted`, you complete their operational deployment:

```
SETUP
  ├── Time
  │    └── Shift Assignments  -> /dashboard/hr/attendance/shift-assignments (Step 4A)
  └── Leave
       ├── Leave Types        -> /dashboard/hr/leaves/types                 (Step 4B)
       └── Leave Policies     -> /dashboard/hr/leaves/policies              (Steps 4C &
  4D)
```

Step 4A: Assign Work Shifts to Accepted Employees

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Shift Assignments` (or `Roster`)
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/attendance/shift-assignments`
- **Primary Function:** Maps the work shift template created in Step 2B to the active employee's profile, establishing their daily expected timetable on the attendance roster.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Navigate to:** `SETUP` > `Time` > `Shift Assignments` (or Roster: `/dashboard/hr/attendance/roster`).
2. **Locate employee:** Find the newly joined employee (`Aman Sharma`) in the roster table or click **`Bulk Assign Shift`**.
3. **Set shift assignment parameters:**
   - **Select Shift Template:** Choose `General Day Shift (9:30 AM - 6:30 PM)` created in Step 2B.
   - **Select Employees:** Check `Aman Sharma` (or filter by Department: `Information Technology`).
   - **Effective From Date:** Select employee's first working day (e.g., `01-11-2026`).
   - **Effective To Date:** Leave blank for an indefinite, ongoing permanent schedule.
4. **Confirm:** Click **`Confirm Shift Assignment`**.
5. **Result:** The employee's monthly attendance matrix is populated with their assigned shift.

Step 4B: Create Leave Types

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Leave` > `Leave Types`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/leaves/types`
- **Primary Function:** Defines individual categories of leave (e.g., Casual Leave, Sick Leave, Maternity Leave) and sets sandwich rules and medical certificate requirements.

Form Fields Specification & Data Dictionary

Field Name	Type & Requirement	Plain Language Explanation & Operational Usage
Name	Text Input `[Required *]`	The formal title of the leave category (e.g., `Casual Leave`, `Sick Leave`).
Code	Text Input `[Required *]`	A short identifier up to 10 characters (e.g., `CL`, `SL`, `ML`).
Description	Textarea `[Optional]`	Guidance outlining appropriate circumstances for submitting this leave type.
Paid Leave Toggle	Toggle Switch `[Optional]`	`ON` = Standard paid day off. `OFF` = Unpaid leave (Leave Without Pay / LWP) resulting in wage deduction.
Count Weekends In Between	Toggle Switch `[Optional]`	**Sandwich Rule:** When `ON`, weekends or holidays falling between two leave days are deducted from quota.
Document Required After	Numeric (days) `[Optional]`	Number of consecutive days that triggers a mandatory medical certificate or document upload (e.g., `2` days).
Who Can Apply (Eligibility)	Checkboxes `[Optional]`	Demographic filters: Restricts leave to specific **Genders** (e.g., Female-only for Maternity) or **Marital Statuses**.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Navigate to:** `SETUP` > `Leave` > `Leave Types` (`/dashboard/hr/leaves/types`).
2. **Click button:** Click the primary `+ Add Leave Type` button at the top-right.
3. **Create Casual Leave (CL):**
   - Enter Name as `Casual Leave` and Code as `CL`.
   - Enter Description: *Short planned leaves for personal affairs or urgent family errands.*
   - Toggle **Paid Leave** to `ON`.
   - Toggle **Count Weekends In Between** to `OFF`.
   - Leave Document Required After as `0`.
   - Leave all Genders and Marital Statuses selected.
   - Click `Save Leave Type`.
4. **Create Sick Leave (SL):**
   - Click `+ Add Leave Type` again.
   - Enter Name as `Sick Leave` and Code as `SL`.
   - Toggle **Paid Leave** to `ON` and **Count Weekends** to `OFF`.
   - Set **Document Required After (days)** to `2` (medical certificate needed for 3+ consecutive days).
   - Click `Save Leave Type`.

Concrete Example Data:

```
# Leave Type 1: Casual Leave
  Name: Casual Leave
  Code: CL
  Description: Short planned leaves for personal work, celebrations, or family errands.
  Paid Leave: Yes (ON)
  Count Weekends In Between: No (OFF)
  Document Required After: 0 (None required)
  Who Can Apply: All Genders, All Marital Statuses

  # Leave Type 2: Sick Leave
  Name: Sick Leave
  Code: SL
  Description: Medical recovery and health-related incapacitation.
  Paid Leave: Yes (ON)
  Count Weekends In Between: No (OFF)
  Document Required After: 2 days (Prescription required for 3+ consecutive days)
  Who Can Apply: All Genders, All Marital Statuses
```

Step 4C: Create Leave Policies (Quota Templates)

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Leave` > `Leave Policies`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/leaves/policies`
- **Primary Function:** Packages individual Leave Types into an annual entitlement policy template, defining annual day counts, monthly accrual rules, and carry-forward limits.

> ***TWO-STEP POLICY ASSEMBLY WORKFLOW:***
>
> 1. *First create the **Policy Template Shell** (Name & operational description).*
> 2. *Then click `Add Quota` on that card to attach individual leave types with their respective annual day allowances and rollover rules.*

Quota Modal Specification & Data Dictionary

Field Name	Type & Requirement	Plain Language Explanation & Operational Usage
Leave Type	Select Dropdown `[Required *]`	Select from Leave Types configured in Step 4B (e.g., `Casual Leave`, `Sick Leave`).
Days Per Year	Numeric (days) `[Required *]`	Total annual day allowance granted to an enrolled staff member (e.g., `12` days).
How Leave Is Given	Radio Select `[Required *]`	`All at once` (full entitlement credited on Jan 1st) vs. `Every month` (accrued monthly, e.g., 1 day/mo).
Unused Days Kept For Next Year	Numeric (days) `[Optional]`	Maximum unused days permitted to carry forward into the subsequent calendar year (e.g., `3` days).
Wait After Joining	Numeric (days) `[Optional]`	Probation waiting period in days before a new hire can use this leave (e.g., `30` days).
Extra Days Allowed Below Zero	Numeric (days) `[Optional]`	Negative leave balance permitted if an employee exhausts their credited quota (Default: `0`).
Leave During Notice Period	Select Dropdown `[Optional]`	Policy during resignation: `Not allowed`, `No limit`, or `Limited`.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Navigate to:** `SETUP` > `Leave` > `Leave Policies` (`/dashboard/hr/leaves/policies`).
2. **Create shell:** Click **`Create Policy`** at top-right. Enter Name as `Standard Full-Time Leave Policy 2026` and enter a Description. Click **`Save Policy Template`**.
3. **Attach Casual Leave quota:** On the newly generated policy card, click **`+ Add Quota`**:
   - Select **Leave Type:** `Casual Leave (CL)`.
   - Enter **Days Per Year:** `12`.
   - Select **How Leave Is Given:** `Every month` (1 day credited at the end of each month).
   - Enter **Unused Days Kept For Next Year:** `3`.
   - Enter **Wait After Joining:** `30` days.
   - Select **Leave During Notice Period:** `Not allowed`.
   - Click **`Save Quota`**.
4. **Attach Sick Leave quota:** Click **`+ Add Quota`** again:
   - Select **Leave Type:** `Sick Leave (SL)`.
   - Enter **Days Per Year:** `10`.
   - Select **How Leave Is Given:** `All at once` (fully credited on Day 1).
   - Enter **Unused Days Kept For Next Year:** `0` (lapses at year-end).
   - Click **`Save Quota`**.

Concrete Example Data:

```
Policy Template Name: Standard Corporate Leave Policy 2026
  Description: Default leave scheme for permanent full-time corporate staff.

  Entitlement 1:
    Leave Type: Casual Leave (CL)
    Days Per Year: 12 days
    Accrual Schedule: Every month (1 day credited per month worked)
    Carry Forward Cap: 3 days max into next year
    Probation Wait Period: 30 days after joining
    Notice Period Rule: Not allowed

  Entitlement 2:
    Leave Type: Sick Leave (SL)
    Days Per Year: 10 days
    Accrual Schedule: All at once (Available on Day 1)
    Carry Forward Cap: 0 days (Lapses on Dec 31)
    Probation Wait Period: 0 days
    Notice Period Rule: Allowed with medical certificate
```

Step 4D: Assign Leave Policies to Employees

- **Sidebar Path:** `SETUP` > `Leave` > `Leave Policies`
- **Direct URL:** `/dashboard/hr/leaves/policies`
- **Primary Function:** Enrolls individual employees or entire departmental cohorts into the configured Leave Policy template, initializing their active leave balances.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Locate policy:** On the **Leave Policies** dashboard, locate the card: `Standard Full-Time Leave Policy 2026`.
2. **Click button:** Click the `Assign` button on the card.
3. **Select targets:**
   - Under **Who is this for:** Select individual staff (e.g., `Aman Sharma`) or check **All employees in Department: Information Technology**.
   - Under **Which Policy:** Verify that `Standard Full-Time Leave Policy 2026` is selected.
   - Review the summary preview displaying annual allowances for CL (12 days) and SL (10 days).
4. **Confirm:** Click `Confirm & Assign Policy`.
5. **Result:** The employee's profile is initialized with their active leave quotas.

Day-to-Day Operations: Team, Inbox & Attendance Monitoring

Once foundational onboarding and policy configurations are complete, HR administrators manage recurring workforce operations through these primary modules:

1. The HR Inbox (`/dashboard/hr/inbox`)

The central operations clearinghouse where pending workforce actions converge:

- **Leave Requests:** Review, approve, or reject employee leave applications with full quota balance visibility.
- **Attendance Corrections:** Fix missed punches and incorrect clock-in times submitted by employees with attached explanations.
- **Overtime Approvals:** Authorize extra hours logged beyond scheduled shift durations.
- **Earned Leave Approvals:** Verify and credit compensatory off requests for weekend or holiday work.
- **Attendance Flags:** Review anomalies flagged by the system (e.g., *Unauthorized Absence*, *Late Punch*, *Out of Geofence Punch*). Click any row to review details and submit a **Resolution Note** to clear the flag.

2. Team Directory (`/dashboard/hr/employees`)

- Complete directory of all staff in card or list view.
- Filter by role: `All` , `HR` , `Manager` , `Employee` .
- Click any employee to inspect their **Attendance Pattern Calendar**, hours worked, leave balances, reporting hierarchy, and statutory compliance files.

3. Daily Attendance (`/dashboard/hr/attendance/daily`)

- Live real-time dashboard of today's attendance across all office locations.
- Monitor who is **Present**, **Late**, on **Half Day**, on **Approved Leave**, or **Absent**.
- Inspect GPS clock-in coordinates, device type, and selfie verification if enabled.

Master Onboarding Checklist for HR Administrators

Print this quick reference checklist and tick off each step as you complete setup for your organization:

Phase	Step	Operational Task Description	Target Portal URL	Status
Phase 1	**1A**	Create Office Location (GPS Geofence & Coordinates)	`/dashboard/hr/attendance/locations`	[ ]
Phase 1	**1B**	Create Organizational Departments & Bind to Location	`/dashboard/hr/departments`	[ ]
Phase 2	**2A**	Create Attendance Policy (Grace mins, Punch modes)	`/dashboard/hr/attendance/policies`	[ ]
Phase 2	**2B**	Create Work Shift Templates (Start/End times, Hours)	`/dashboard/hr/attendance/shifts`	[ ]
Phase 2	**2C**	Configure Public & Regional Holiday Calendar	`/dashboard/hr/attendance/holidays`	[ ]
Phase 2	**2D**	Configure Weekly Off Rules (5-Day / Alternate Sat)	`/dashboard/hr/attendance/weekly-offs`	[ ]
Phase 2	**2E**	Create Earned Leave (Comp-Off) Accumulation Rules	`/dashboard/hr/attendance/comp-off-policies`	[ ]
Phase 3	**3A**	Issue Employee Onboarding Invites via 4-Step Wizard	`/dashboard/hr/invites`	[ ]
Phase 3	**3B**	Employee Receives 48-Hour Email Link & Sets Password	*Secure Email Gateway*	[ ]
Phase 4	**4A**	Assign Shift Template in Roster / Shift Assignments	`/dashboard/hr/attendance/shift-assignments`	[ ]
Phase 4	**4B**	Create Statutory & Company Leave Types (CL, SL, ML)	`/dashboard/hr/leaves/types`	[ ]
Phase 4	**4C**	Assemble Leave Policy Templates & Attach Quotas	`/dashboard/hr/leaves/policies`	[ ]
Phase 4	**4D**	Assign Leave Policy to Onboarded Personnel	`/dashboard/hr/leaves/policies`	[ ]

Formal Operational Sign-Off

This document certifies that all foundational setup procedures, shifts, attendance policies, and leave quotas have been verified against active company policies and deployed successfully onto the HrClouds platform.

```
HR Operations Lead Signature:       _____________________________    Date: _____________

  System Administrator Verification:  _____________________________    Date: ____________
  __

  Organization Name:                  _____________________________    Branch: __________
  ___
```

HrClouds HRMS User Onboarding & Setup Master Guide — Clean, compact, and optimized for high-fidelity PDF printing.